

Procurement and Tender Rules for Universities — Rules Notification

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Issued in 2025 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/RUL/2025/021, this rules notification establishes the arrangements supporting Procurement and Tender Rules for Universities. In scope are Procurement, Tendering, Vendors, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Background and Scope

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this rules notification to give effect to Procurement, Tendering. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Procurement as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present rules notification responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

Purpose

This rules notification is intended to translate the objectives of Procurement and Tender Rules for Universities into actionable direction for institutions, officials and other stakeholders, ensuring that Procurement is pursued in a structured and accountable manner.

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Procurement, Tendering across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

Goals

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Procurement, Tendering, Vendors, with clear lines of accountability.

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Procurement, Tendering, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

Coverage

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Procurement within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

Core Provisions

Institutions are required to integrate Procurement, Tendering into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Procurement, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Tendering.

Implementation Arrangements

Institutions are expected to appoint a lead authority for implementation, adapt the framework to local context, and report progress to Higher Education Department in line with the prescribed cycle.

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

Institutional Responsibilities

Clear allocation of responsibility is expected at institutional level, with Higher Education Department acting as the coordinating authority for evaluation, escalation and cross-institutional learning.

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Procurement, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Monitoring and Evaluation

Monitoring covers both compliance and quality, combining documented evidence with stakeholder feedback to build a complete picture of institutional performance over time.

Closing Note

This document is designed to evolve with institutional experience. Feedback from stakeholders will shape refinements, ensuring that the framework remains practical, proportionate and fit for purpose.